10

INDIA'S US POLICY UNDER MODI

Alignment and strategic autonomy redefined

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In June 2016, Narendra Modi made his fourth visit to the United States as Indian Prime Minister to address a joint session of the US Congress. Charting out a new vision for the future, he proclaimed that finally India–US ties have "overcome the hesitations of history."[1] Within two months of his address, India and the United States agreed to sign a long-pending foundational defence agreement: the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement (LEMOA). First proposed in 2006, it took approximately a decade for India to sign the agreement, mostly because New Delhi remained unsure of a close defence partnership with the United States. The ideological remnants of the Cold War adversarial relationship, underpinned by India's preference for "non-alignment," were in part responsible; so was a leadership which was short on authority, if not conviction.

Since the end of the Cold War, successive Indian governments have signalled a commitment to a robust